

The Godhead Mediated Through Abraham

We are going to continue in Galatians, this time around the sixteenth verse.

At Antioch, Paul withstood Peter to his face because Peter was to be blamed. Certain men came from James and the church in Jerusalem. When they came, Peter and some of the other Jews stopped eating with the Gentiles. Barnabas was also caught up in the dissimulation, which is another word for hypocrisy.

Those Judaizers moved from Antioch to Galatia. A Judaizer believed that a Gentile could become Abraham's seed through Jesus Christ, but then had to go on and keep the law to be perfected.

So Paul says to the Galatians, "You want to go back under the law? Then hear what the law says."

He asks:

"Who hath bewitched you?"

Who is practicing witchcraft on you, that you could believe you began in the spirit, born again and freed from sin, and could then be perfected by the law?

Romans and Galatians are difficult to understand without a working knowledge of the purpose of the law. People quote verses out of both books and sometimes wrestle them to their own destruction. They use statements like "It is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me" to excuse themselves from responsibility.

But if you understand the purpose and nature of the law, you can understand grace. To have the kind of faith Paul preached, the kind that moves mountains and stomps devils, you have to understand when the old covenant gave way to sonship and how sin lost its dominion.

The Lord knew I would not have broken cadence in my teaching, because this hour is designed for teaching. So He took the thought from my mind for a moment and brought tongues forward.

As the interpretation came, this was the sense of it:

Did I not warn you that discouragement would come? Did I not warn you that those who could be discouraged would be discouraged? Know this, that darkness becomes darkest as Satan gathers his hosts of darkness, knowing his time is short for his last onslaughts. He has noticed the gathering of spiritual things and knows he can only withhold this for a short time.

So be encouraged and be strong, says the Lord, for the atmosphere around you is changing as heaven orders things to be moved here and there for the outpouring that is to come. Strengthen yourself. Do not back up, but enter in and fight the good fight of faith. The time is short, and you will see many of the things begin that I have promised you.

Many sowers will catch up with the reaper. You will carry the flames of revival like firebrands. Wherever you land, you will ignite revival because you yourself will be consumed.

If a person is going to have ultimate faith, not just spurts of ministry, but longevity, he must understand who he is and what he has.

Many ministries have been canceled out because the enemy entered through an area that was not strengthened in the Word. Wherever Jesus and who they were in Him had not been built up, the enemy reprogrammed that part and pulled them down.

At the end of my days, I want my testimony to be:

"I have fought a good fight,
I have kept the faith."

That is becoming more important to me all the time.

Romans 7 shows the Jew who received the law and could not keep it. He cries, "Who will save me from this body of death?" Between Romans 7 and 8, the change comes into sonship through Jesus Christ.

Romans 8 says we have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear. That was the spirit received from Adam, which produced bondage and fear even when the Jew tried to serve God under the law.

We have received the spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, "Abba, Father." The Holy Spirit bears witness with our spirit that we have become sons of God.

Understanding who you are in sonship is the key to longevity.

Galatians 3:16 says:

"Now to Abraham and his seed were the promises made.
He saith not, And to seeds, as of many;
but as of one,
And to thy seed, which is Christ."

The promises were made to Abraham and to his Seed, singular, which is Christ. In reality, everything God promised to Abraham, He was promising through Abraham to Christ.

Galatians 3:17 says:

"And this I say,
that the covenant, that was confirmed before of God in Christ,
the law, which was four hundred and thirty years after,
cannot disannul,
that it should make the promise of none effect."

The covenant God made with Abraham was confirmed before God in Christ. The law came four hundred and thirty years later and could not cancel that first covenant or make the promise ineffective.

Galatians 3:18 says:

"For if the inheritance be of the law,
it is no more of promise:
but God gave it to Abraham by promise."

Galatians 3:19 says:

"Wherefore then serveth the law?
It was added because of transgressions,
till the seed should come to whom the promise was made;
and it was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator."

The law was added because of transgressions until the Seed, Christ, should come.

For a long time, I thought the mediator here was Moses, because that is how many commentaries explain it. They say the law was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator, meaning Moses.

But as long as I put Moses in that verse, I got stuck. I would meditate on, "A mediator is not a mediator of one, but God is one," and wonder, "If Moses is the mediator and God is one, who is the other party?"

Then one day the Holy Spirit broke through. You cannot keep praying in the Holy Ghost and not have breakthrough, because tongues is a revelation gift.

The King James adds words in italics to help the reading. In Galatians 3:19, the phrase "and it was" is supplied. The thought is smoother if we see that Paul is still talking about the promise:

The law was added because of transgressions until the Seed should come, to whom the promise was made, ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator.

What was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator? The promise God made to Abraham.

The law was spoken through Moses at Sinai, with thunder, lightning, and darkness around the mountain. That darkness represented the spiritual death of humanity. But in Genesis 22, when God addressed Abraham after Isaac was offered, the angel of the Lord called from heaven and said the promise would surely be fulfilled.

The promise to Abraham was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator.

Hebrews 6:13 says:

"For when God made promise to Abraham,
because he could swear by no greater,
he swore by himself."

We often think that means God simply said, "I am God, and there is no one greater than Me, so I swear by Myself." But God already is who He is. He does not have to explain that He is God when He makes a promise.

When the Holy Spirit flashed Hebrews 6 into my spirit alongside Galatians 3, I saw that this was about the Godhead and the promised Seed.

A mediator is not a mediator of one. A mediator stands between two parties. Yet God is one.

So who were the two parties? Abraham was standing as mediator between God and God: the Father and the Seed, Christ, the second Person of the Godhead who would enter the earth through Abraham's line.

God could swear by no greater, so He swore by Himself. He made the promise through Abraham to His own Seed, Christ.

John 1 says:

"In the beginning was the Word,
and the Word was with God,
and the Word was God."

The Word, the Logos, was with God and was God. All things were made by Him. Then John says:

"In him was life;
and the life was the light of men."

There John moves from the deity of the Logos to His humanity. The life in Him was the first human spirit to be born spiritually alive in four thousand years. That light shined in the darkness, and the darkness did not comprehend it.

At the time God made covenant with Abraham, the second Person of the Godhead was known as the mighty Logos. God needed a way to bring Him into the earth. He did it through the Holy Spirit and the virgin Mary, but He also needed an avenue into human flesh through a covenant line.

So He found a man named Abraham and mediated the covenant through him.

God, who is one, brought Abraham in as mediator. Through Abraham, the Father swore to His own Seed, Christ, that the promise would come to pass.

Hebrews says God could swear by no greater, so He swore by Himself. That means the promises do not rest merely on God promising you; He promised Himself concerning you.

Because He could swear by no greater, He swore by Himself that you could become His sons and daughters. He swore by Himself that He would remove disease from your midst, give you His inheritance, give you peace, send the Holy Ghost to seal you, and back the preaching of His Son with power.

When you say, "God, You promised me," He can answer, "More than that. I promised Myself concerning you."

The Holy Ghost can take what Jesus made me and quicken it forward because God swore by Himself to perform everything He promised. You, the devil, and circumstances cannot stop that kind of promise.

God will give you the wisdom you need to rise up and take what belongs to you. Do not think like a beggar. You are a son.

You need enough faith to stand in the devil's face hour after hour and say, "I will not accept this. This is what God said about me."

If circumstances are against you, stay in there until you change them. You are not begging for God to consider you. You are standing inside a promise God swore by Himself.

From glory to glory, He is changing you. It makes you wonder what else is in the Word.